

To select more than one icon at the same time, click the first icon, then hold down Shift and click the rest of the icons. The Shift key is a signal to the Finder that it should add the new icon to the group of selected icons instead of making it the only selected icon. You can also shift-click a selected icon to unselect it, should you select one you didn't mean to select. To unselect all icons, click any other icon that's not already selected, or click anywhere that's *not* an icon. Here's a summary of what happens when you click and shift-click in the Finder:

- Click an unselected icon: The clicked icon is selected; all other icons are un-selected.
- Shift-click an unselected icon: The clicked icon is selected; other icons stay selected.
- Shift-click a selected icon: The clicked icon is un-selected; other icons stay selected.
- Click anywhere that's not an icon: All selected icons are un-selected.

You can also select icons by dragging a rectangle around them. To try this out, point to a spot just below and to the right of the Trash. (Don't actually position the pointer on the Trash itself; if you do, you'll end up dragging the Trash around the screen.) Press the mouse button and drag upward and to the left. As you do, a rectangle will appear. One corner is anchored at the point where you started dragging. The corner of the rectangle *diagonally opposite* the fixed corner is attached to the mouse pointer. Drag the mouse until the rectangle surrounds all the icons on your screen, then release the button. All the icons enclosed—or even touched—by the rectangle turn black. If you need to select a group of icons without un-selecting the icons you have already selected, hold down the Shift key while dragging a rectangle around them.

■ Shortcut

To select all the icons, pull down the Edit menu and choose "Select All" (or press ⌘-A). "Select All" is especially useful when you want to work with most of the icons, but not all of them—just choose "Select All," then shift-click the icons that you don't want.

Opening Icons

Once you've selected an icon (or a group of icons), it's natural to want to see what's inside it. To do this, just pull down the File menu and select "Open" (or press ⌘-O). Since we're working with disk icons (and the Trash, which acts like a disk icon even though it really isn't), opening the icon will produce a window displaying the contents of the disk or the Trash. Try it on the disk in the upper right corner of the screen (see Figure 6C).

■ Shortcut

To open icons more easily, just double-click them. If you selected a group of icons, double-click any blackened icon to open them all. If you want to open a single icon, you don't need to click it first to select it—the double-click will select the icon and open it. We don't know anyone who ever actually uses the "Open" option on the Finder's File menu.

The window that appears is a standard IIGS Desktop window and can be manipulated like any other Desktop window. If you haven't had a chance to practice moving and resizing windows, you might want to turn back to Chapter 5 and try it out. Otherwise, close the window you opened by clicking its close box or by choosing "Close" from the File menu (or pressing ⌘-W).